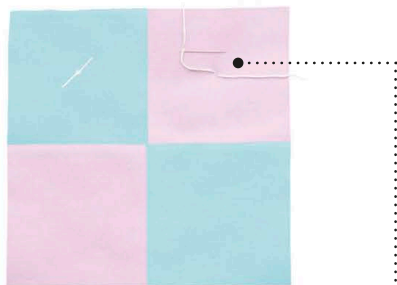


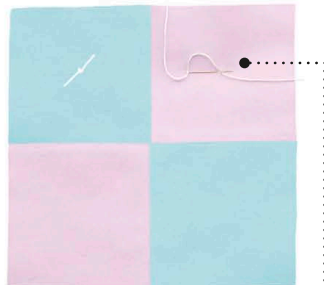
► TYING

This involves tying lengths of cotton thread, lightweight wool, or ribbon through the layers of a quilt to hold them together. Use a sharp-pointed needle with an eye that is large enough to hold the thread but small enough to avoid making holes in the quilt. Space the

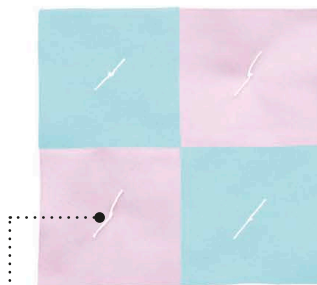
ties according to the type of wadding, the block pattern, and the size of the quilt. Cotton and wool wadding shift easily and should be tied more closely than polyester. A general guide is 10–15cm (4–6in) apart.



1 Working from the centre out, take a stitch down and back up through all the layers and pull the needle and thread through, leaving a 10cm (4in) tail on the top.



2 Take a second stitch in the same way in the same place.



3 Tie the ends of thread in a reef knot. Cut the thread from the reel and trim the ends to the same length. Repeat, double-stitching and knotting over the entire quilt.

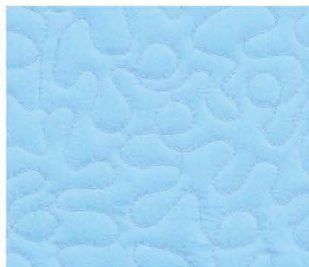
► FREESTYLE OR FREE-MOTION QUILTING

Freestyle, or free-motion, quilting gives machine quilters freedom to create their own designs. Mastering the technique requires patience and practice, but the effort can be very rewarding. You need a darning foot

or a free-motion foot and to know how to lower the feed dogs. If your machine has the option to stop work with the needle always down, use it.



1 With the presser foot down where you will start, take one stitch. Hold the top thread and use it to gently pull the bobbin thread to the top. Secure with a few very short stitches. Start slowly and take a few more short stitches. Cut away the thread tails.



2 Guide the fabric with your hands, moving the work in any direction. Position your hands in an open circle around the machine foot and press the layers gently. Keep a moderate speed and make the stitches the same length. Tie off with a few short stitches, as in Step 1.

TROUBLESHOOTING

